

Polar exploration: an exceptional journey

The Solar Orbiter satellite is a true explorer. Just as scientists set sail more than 100 years ago for the Earth’s freezing polar regions, Solar Orbiter is hurling towards uncharted territories close to the hot solar poles. A heat shield is no luxury.

Both expeditions, to the Earth’s and solar poles, have to withstand harsh conditions. Equipped with instruments and cameras, they brave storms and extreme temperatures to advance science and to go where no one has gone before.



Scientific story telling as an engaging and powerful tool

to share complex science, especially when it is told as a **personal** journey. It helps to understand and remember. Science becomes more trustable and can inspire.

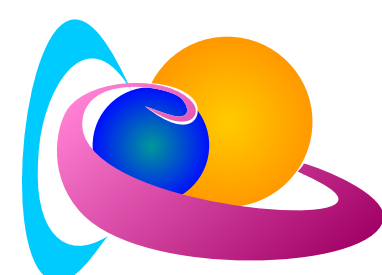
Both stories, Belgica and Solar Orbiter, touche similar themes. We took the **need to explore, financing, the international character, unforeseen situations and misfortunes, discoveries, future and legacy.**

Engage in a discussion with the public:

- Who should pay: rich people, the government, companies, ...?
- Does there need to be societal relevance?
- Why can’t research be national? How do people with different background communicate and work together?
- What should happen when things go wrong?
- Is travelling to conferences worldwide justified? What about the ecological aspect?

In practice: we will organise a pop-up theatre play that combines the story of Adrien De Gerlache, commander the of Belgica and the experiences of David Berghmans, principal investigator of EU1 onboard of Solar Orbiter.

Petra Vanlommel, Solar-Terrestrial Centre of Excellence and David Berghmans, Royal Observatory of Belgium.
Support: Anik De Groof, ESA and Elke D’Huys, Solar-Terrestrial Centre of Excellence



Solar-Terrestrial Centre
of
Excellence



Royal Observatory
of Belgium

